WEEK 38 · 14–19 SEPTEMBER 2026

2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

Week 38 Delivery Report

What moved this week, initiative by initiative, with the delivery schedule it sits in.

Cyber & Infra · Data · Core · Sector Intelligence · D&E · University Services

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Cyber & Infra 1 INITIATIVE

Outcomes. 1 initiatives moved, led by Strengthen Cyber Security. QS's external cybersecurity rating increased by a further five points, strengthening the organisation's position as an established A-tier organisation in the eyes of independent cybersecurity risk-rating providers (UpGuard).

Risks & decisions. Strengthen Cyber Security: Box platform constraints. Discovery sessions continue to reinforce that Box configurations and business processes are highly interconnected.

Core 5 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 5 initiatives moved, led by MyQS Cerebrum, MyQS CX – Ph 2, QAS Auth. A second estate stood up in a week.

Risks & decisions. Nothing raised this week.

Sector Intelligence 5 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 5 initiatives moved, led by QAS Stars, Rankings Template, 1 Mentor IBM. A second estate stood up in a week.

Risks & decisions. MoveIN Smart Match / AI Email: Penetration test reports under evaluation; any findings requiring remediation could create additional work. OpenAI Assistants API deprecation: an alternative has been identified. Penetration test reports under evaluation.

D&E 2 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 2 initiatives moved, led by TU – Career Match Microsite, TU Performance & Upgrade. Angular upgrade done, from version 14 to 21, no issues reported and no downtime. GME rankings released. This has been tested, is waiting for release.

Risks & decisions. QS RMS (CN) CSV upload. Requires development-team optimisation. Automox. Approval remains pending with the DPO team. Bitdefender. Approval and legal documentation remain pending. Hubl staging.

University Services 2 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 2 initiatives moved, led by Appian to Hubspot Migration, Decommission Informatica. The team continues to focus on Appian production support, while progressing with the discovery phase of the Appian migration.

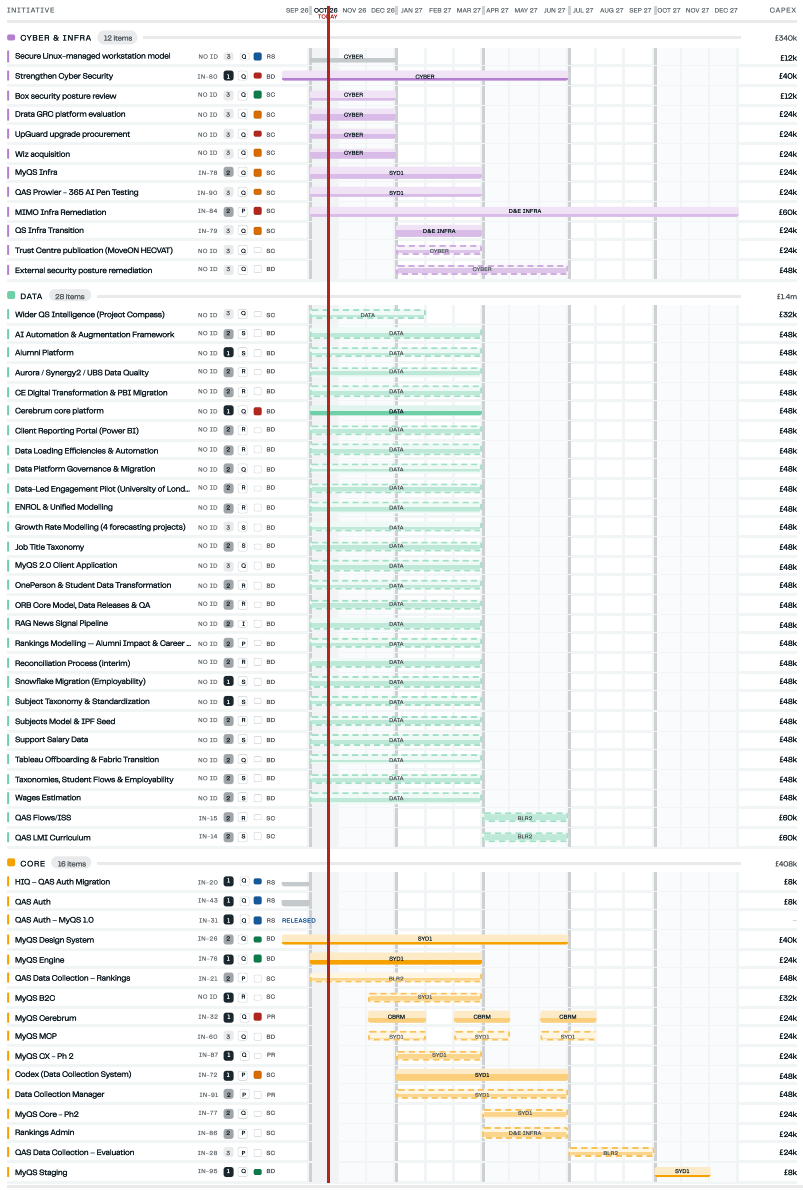
Risks & decisions. Appian to Hubspot Migration: Contact Matching unavailable in Sandbox: issues promoting data from production to sandbox due to missing data objects. Decommission Informatica: Informatica will not be renewed.

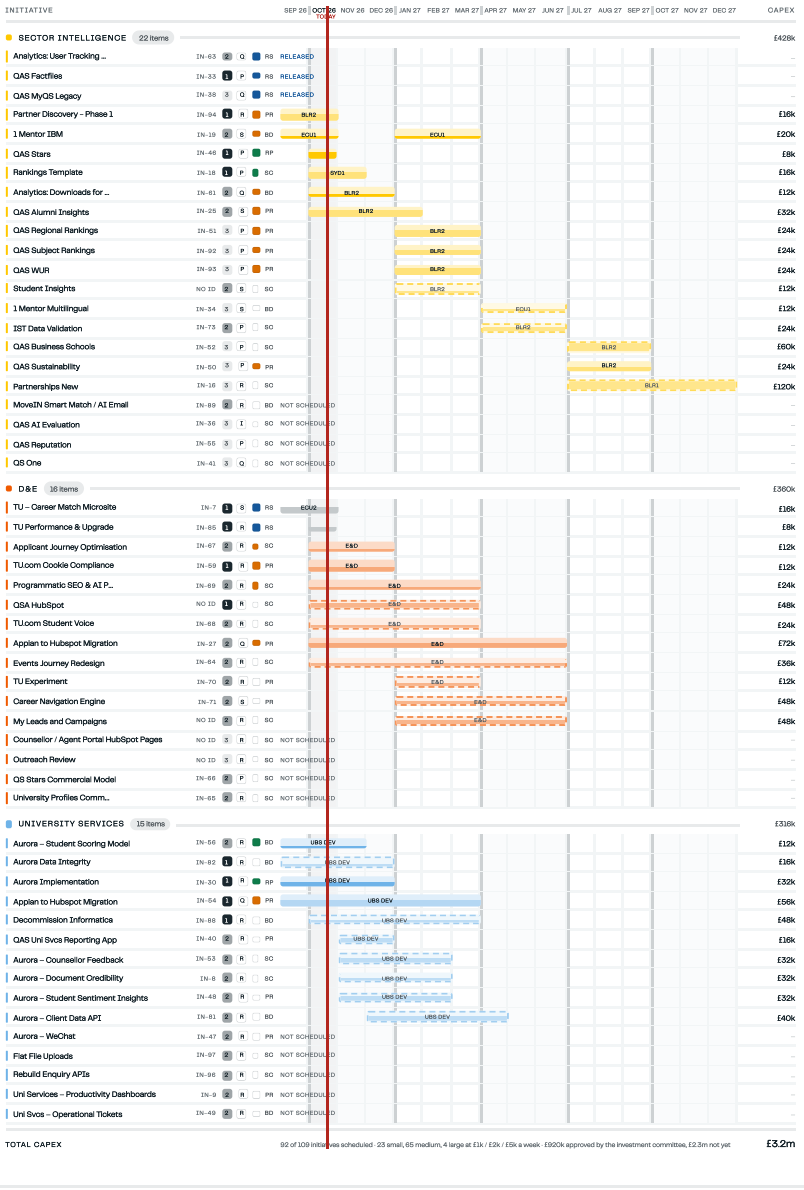
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2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

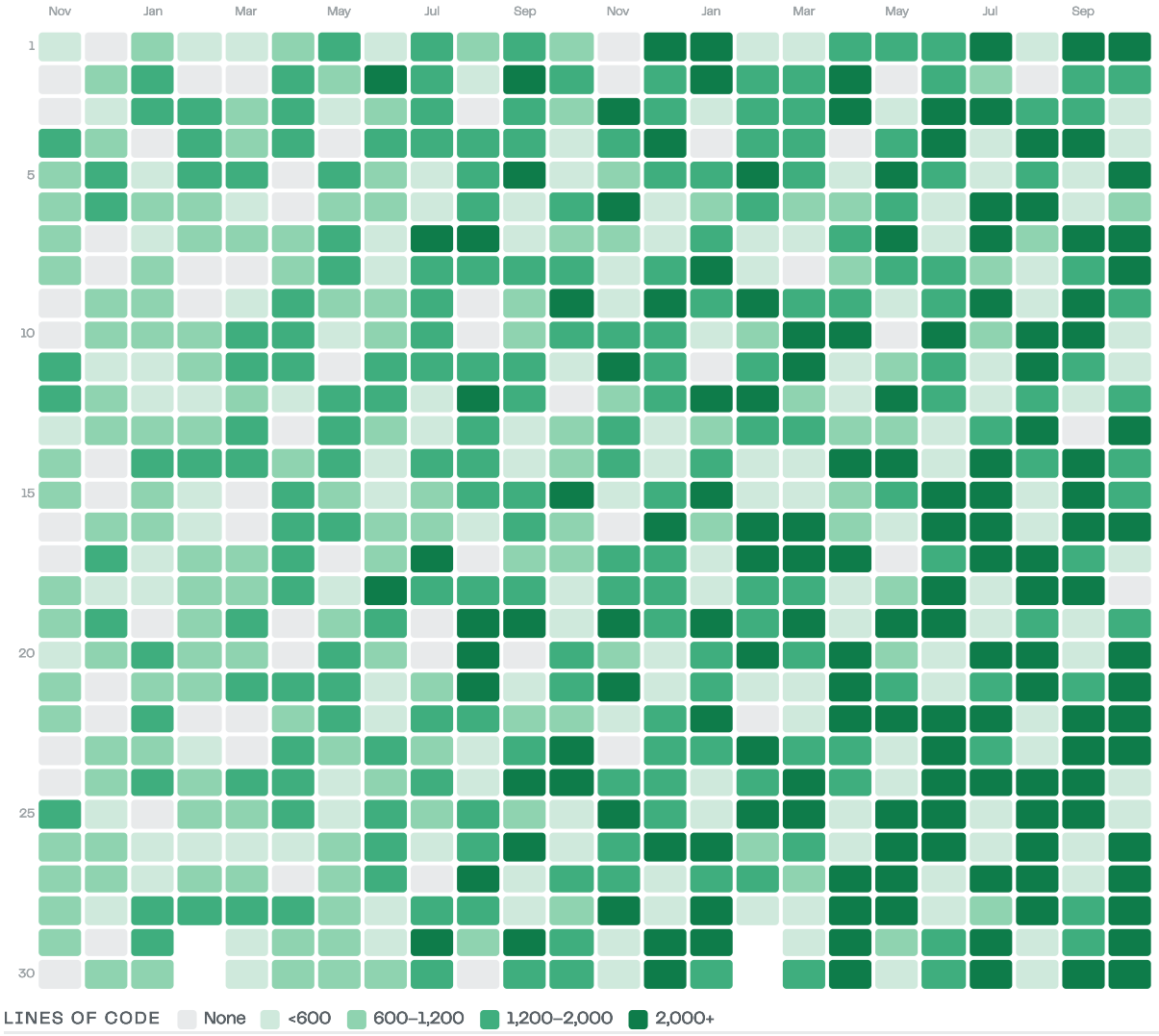
Delivery schedule 109 initiatives





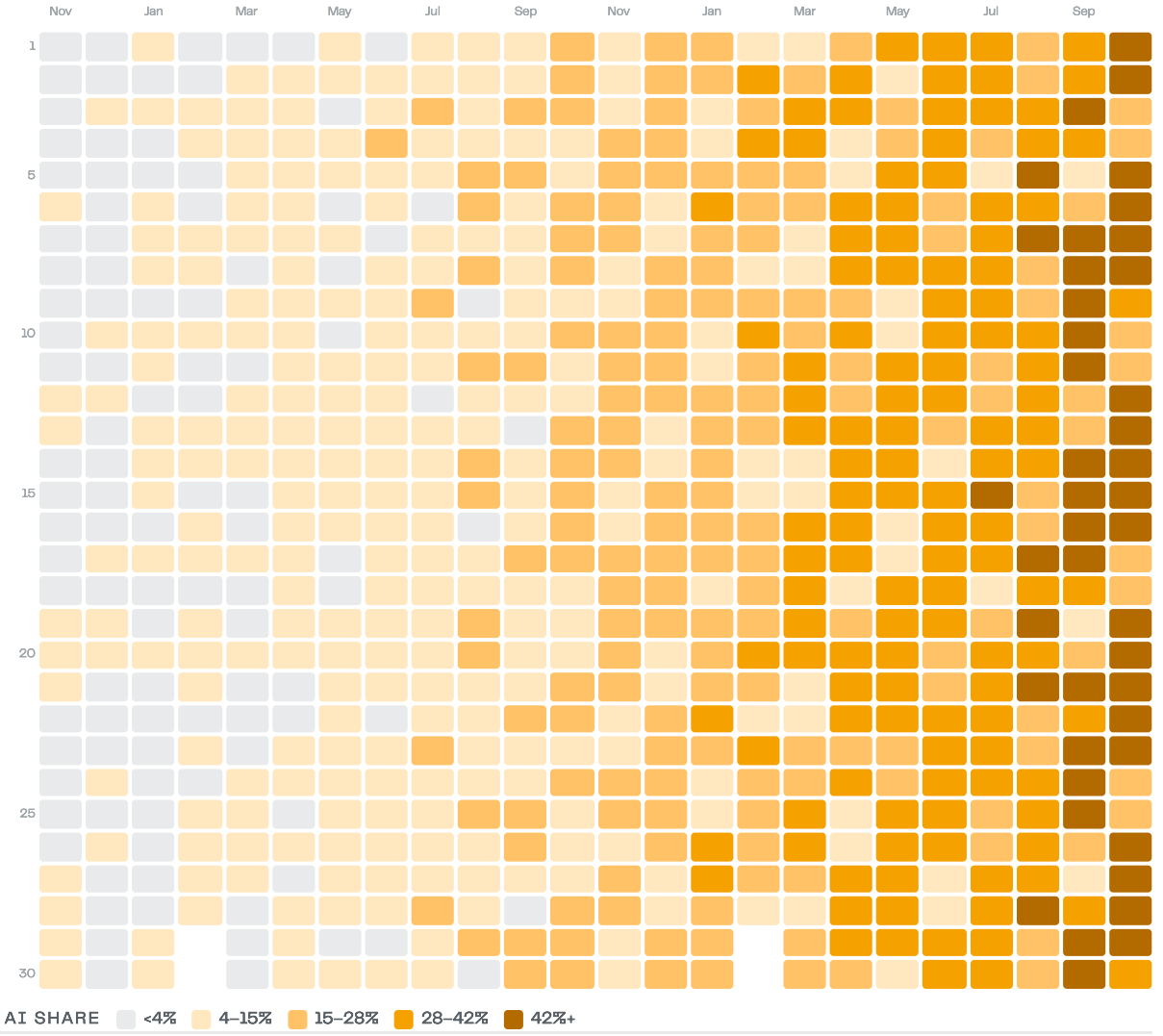
Productivity Heatmap NOV 24 – OCT 26

Lines of code committed a day.



AI Code Intensity NOV 24 – OCT 26

Share of committed code written by AI.



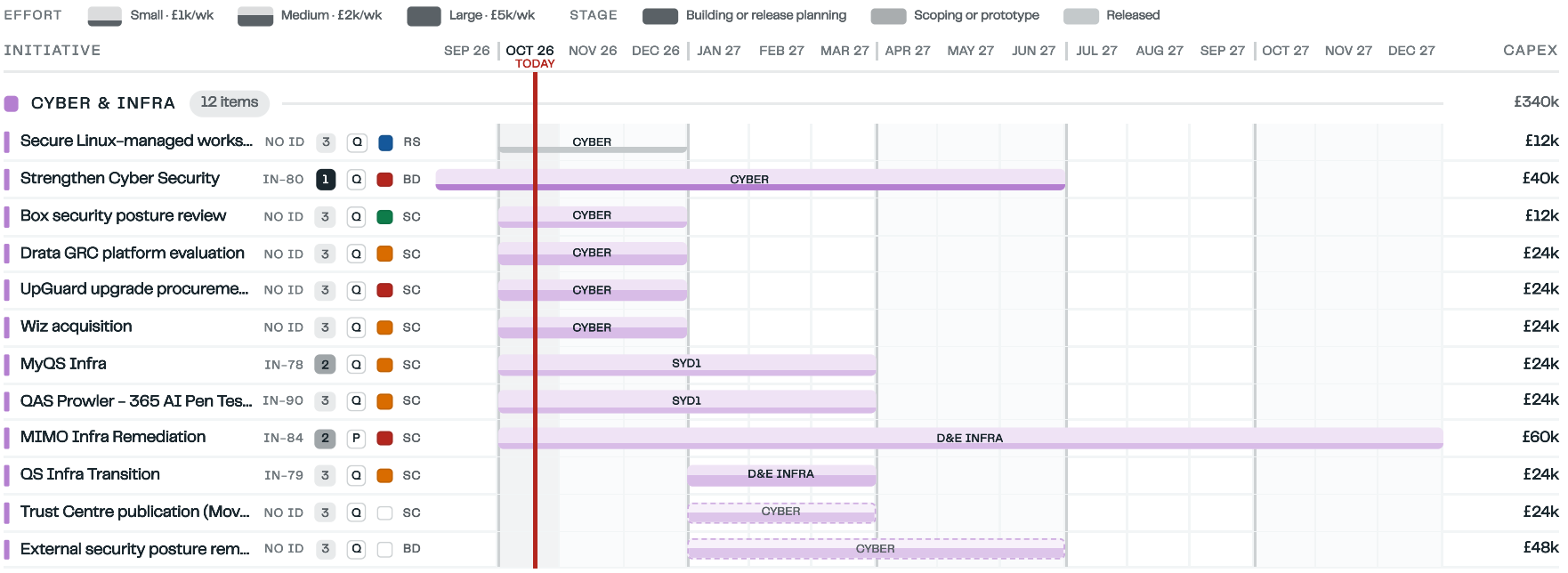
Cyber & Infra 1 initiative

SECTION 1 OF 5

Cyber & Infra

1 initiative reported

1 building



TOTAL CAPEX — 12 of 12 initiatives scheduled · 6 small, 6 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £268k approved by the investment committee, £72k not yet — £340k

Strengthen Cyber Security

IN-80 · CYBER · CYBER · ROWAN CHAPMAN · BUILDING

Drata PoV concluded; CSPM and TPRM procurement; Box discovery; D&E compliance assessment; CrowdStrike AI security workshop; MoveOn pen testing; UpGuard rating +5. Completed the evaluation of Drata and assessed the platform as suitable for QS. The solution demonstrated strong capability across continuous compliance monitoring, policy management, risk management and ISO governance requirements. The Compliance team has requested an extension to undertake further evaluation before a final recommendation is made. Met with Procurement to review proposed Cybersecurity Posture Management (CSPM) and Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) solutions. Provided additional context on business justifications, procurement requirements and vendor quotations.

Risks and decisions. Box platform constraints. Discovery sessions continue to reinforce that Box configurations and business processes are highly interconnected. This may significantly limit the security controls that can be introduced without broader operational impacts. D&E compliance gap.

Cyber

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Box platform constraints. Discovery sessions continue to reinforce that Box configurations and business processes are highly interconnected. This may significantly limit the security controls that can be introduced without broader operational impacts. D&E compliance gap. The D&E environment remains non-compliant with vulnerability and patch management standards. While remediation activities are under way, oversight and prioritisation will be required to address identified gaps.

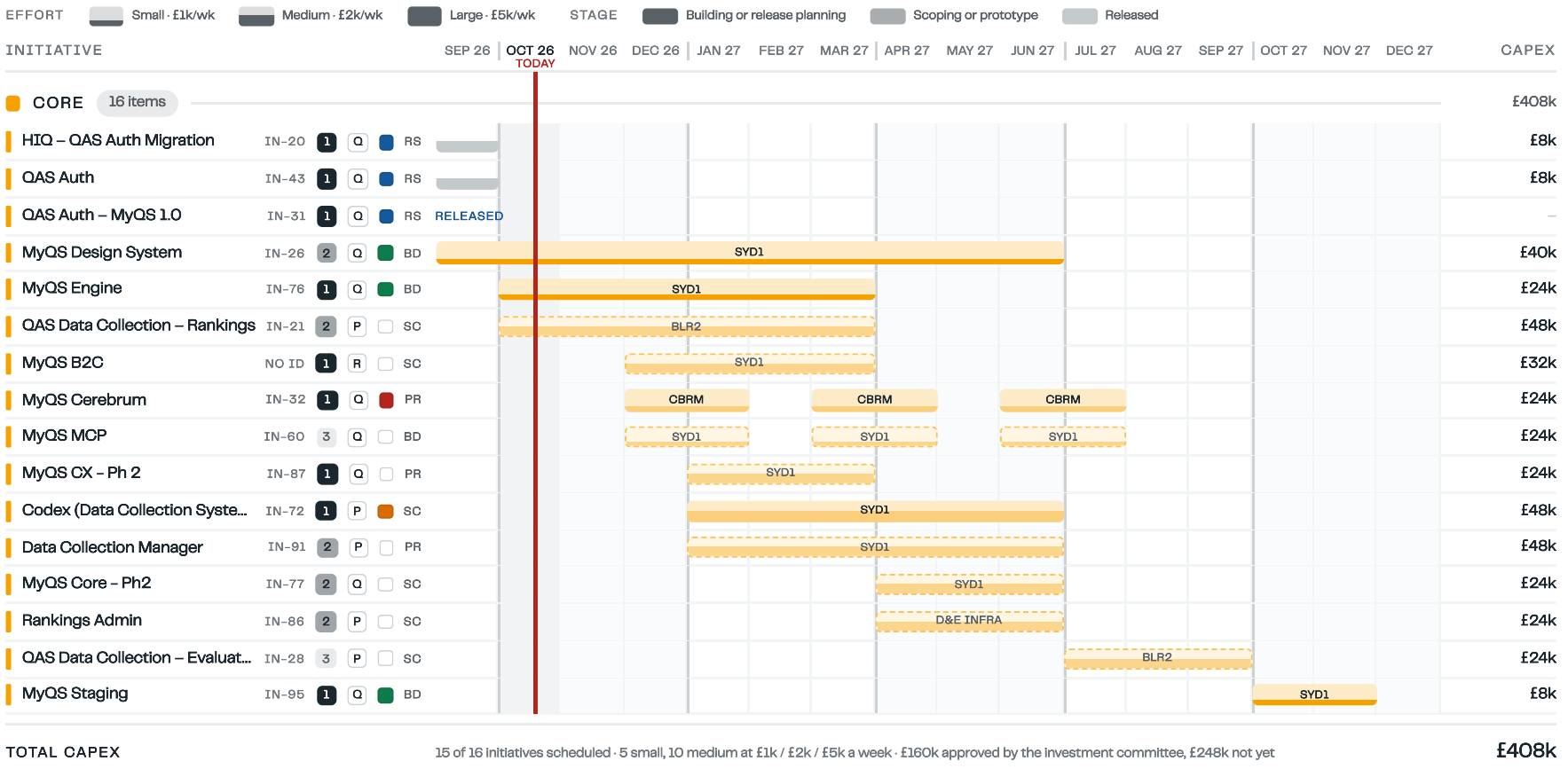
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 2 OF 5

Core

5 initiatives reported

1 scoping
2 prototype
1 building
1 released



TOTAL CAPEX — 15 of 16 initiatives scheduled · 5 small, 10 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £160k approved by the investment committee, £248k not yet — £408k

MyQS Cerebrum

IN-32 · CEREBRUM · CEREBRUM · NICOLAS JOURDAIN · PROTOTYPE

QS Identity Ledger live in Aurora with Snowflake replica, sync job, ingest gate and UI panel. Registry API per-version enums, REFERENCE edges, natural-key canonicalisation. Aurora is the ledger of record (resolve-or-issue, source systems, key store), Snowflake holds the replica, a 10-minute sync job keeps it current, entity ingest is gated on it, and the entity page shows bound references with retract/retire. Spans the API, dbt, Dagster, CBR-Infra and the FE. 502s on keys/retract fixed, DERIVED ids no longer registered, sync scripts run from outside the VPC, mint ceiling raised to 1,000.

MyQS CX – Ph 2

IN-87 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · PROTOTYPE

CX territory, sales manager and CSM filters; account and product filters on product access. MyQS MFA enrolment, passkey removal. Cerebrum shell drawer. CX gained territory, sales manager and CSM filters plus account and product filters on product access; MyQS asks Auth0 to enrol an authenticator rather than verify one, keeps enrolment reachable when the popup is blocked, shows a truthful MFA row, and lets a user remove a passkey; Cerebrum opens the QS Agent in the shell drawer. All on qas-design 2.1.46.

QAS Auth

IN-43 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · RELEASED

prod asset origin moved to eu-west-2; implicit grant dropped; MFA enrolment and passkey management; protected account provisioning. The prod asset origin moved to eu-west-2 with the ACUL bundles rebuilt and re-pinned, the implicit grant dropped from both staging clients, rr allowed on both tenants, MyQS1 staging callbacks pinned to wildcards, and a protected account's own admin able to provision any product inside it.

MyQS Core – Ph2

IN-77 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · SCOPING

QS Supergraph staging as first delivery branch; eu-west-1 estate; Stars migration stage; rr registration; us-east-1 target retired. Staging made the first delivery branch with promotion to production by pull request, the eu-west-1 estate added to the delivery stack, a MigrateDatabase stage for Stars, rr registered, the account CX identifiers re-exposed on staging, and the us-east-1 target retired. The Recruitment Admin subgraph now notifies the federation as a GitHub App with organisation-level credentials, and committed its leaderboard score migration.

MyQS Design System

IN-26 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · BUILDING

2.1.39 through 2.1.46; StructureToolbar, RankBoard, rankings board page; launcher tile for Rankings Template alpha. 2.1.39 through 2.1.46: StructureToolbar, RankBoard and the rankings board page shipped from the package, apps able to feed the analytics reports and rank board with their own rows, and the Rankings Template alpha tile in the launcher.

SYD1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Staging estate (eu-west-1): The Auth API, Pulse, the federation, the Auth DB (tunnel, bootstrap, environment map, first CX admin seeded, the two protected accounts and the product catalogue mirrored from production), the prototypes and Stars all deployed to eu-west-1; four platform ingress hosts published from the staging zone; staging MyQS and MyQS1 clients with prototype and local-dev origins; the MFA Always outage on staging recorded and re-armed after SES production access. us-east-1 retirement: The prod and dev environments retired, the frozen Stars GraphQL service and the federation target retired, the dev-estate targets dropped from the Auth API and Pulse, and the platform audience removed from the JWT authoriser.

Cerebrum

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

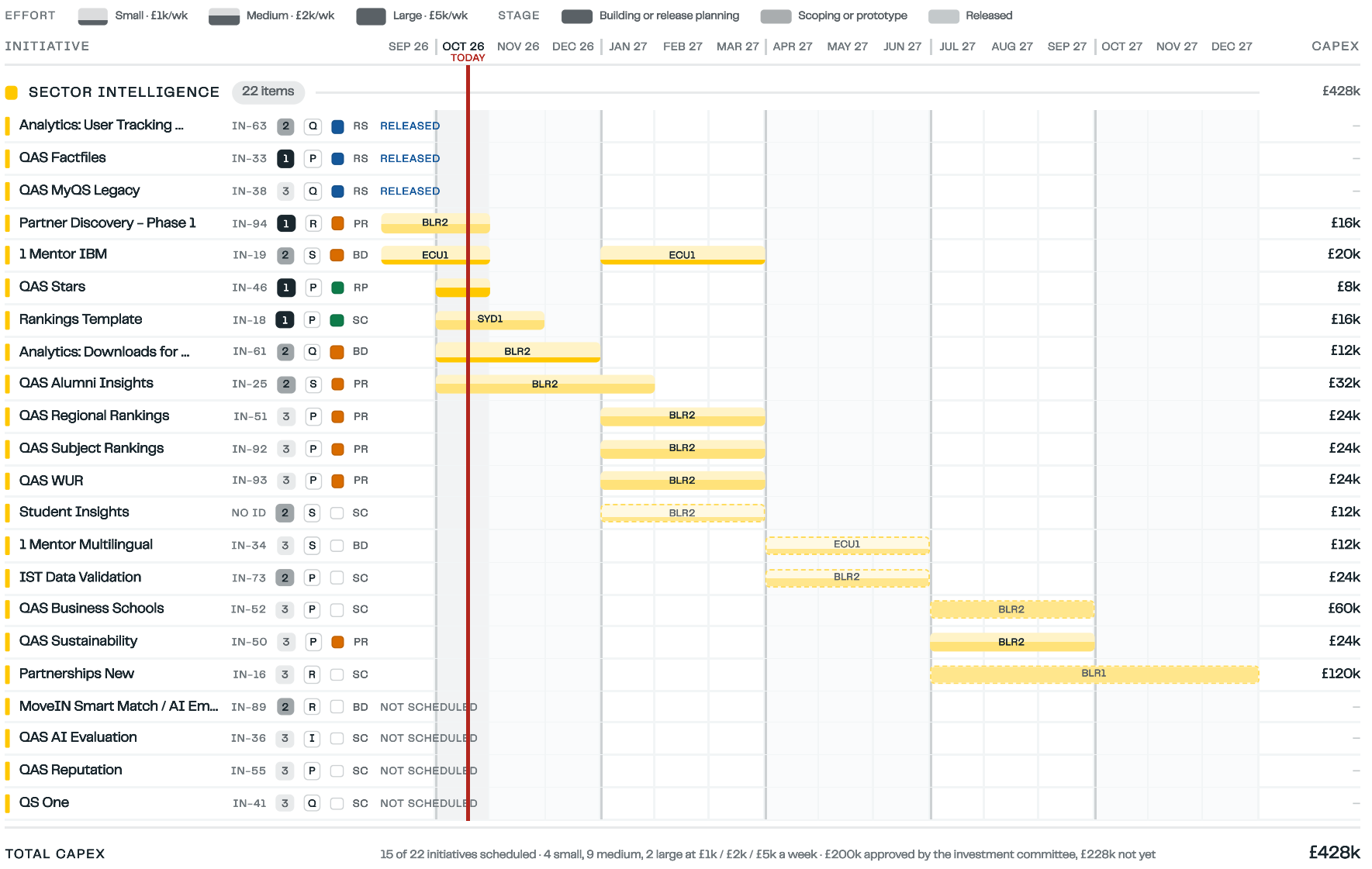
Entity-types UI tidy and Amplify build fix: QS ID method and schema version columns, Active Schema section dropped, lockfile restored so npm 10 builds again. Handover alignment and qs_mapping retirement: Two CBR-Infra SQL changes waiting on the manual apply; the qs_mapping drop is dry-run clean but not applied. Rankings asset lands in the pipeline: crystalng-qs: rankings asset and job in Dagster, four dbt changes including Dagster Pipes. Dagster stack opened to sister teams: dynamic code-location management, 1mentor onboarded, an AWS access-policies stack, and concurrency/conflict groups for sensor jobs.

SECTION 3 OF 5

Sector Intelligence

5 initiatives reported

2 scoping
2 building
1 release planning



QAS Stars

IN-46 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · RELEASE PLANNING

Stars served as a Federation 2 subgraph with product guard; Snowflake sync Lambda; deployed to staging. Served as a Federation 2 subgraph with the product guard, the Snowflake sync pipeline shipped as a Lambda image, both Stars roles granted on every table with the per-estate data bring-up documented, and the federation notified when main moves; the front end queries the federated router, points its onboarding pickers at the app's own graph, and is hosted in production.

Rankings Template

IN-18 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · SCOPING

Rankings Template (rr) alpha registered with launcher tile; RR front end rebuilt on qas-design board views; hosted in production. Registered as the rr alpha app with a launcher tile and allowed on the staging and prod MyQS clients; Caitlin rebuilt the RR front end around the template on qas-design board views, shipping StructureToolbar, RankBoard and the rankings board page from the package; hosted in production.

1 Mentor IBM

IN-19 · ECU1/ECU2 · ECU1 AND ECU2 · JONNATHAN PENA AND PAULA JIMINEZ · ECU1 AND ECU2 · BUILDING

IBM went live; release 74.18.4 certified and deployed. 1 Mentor is now live with IBM. The Product team confirmed they were impressed with the platform.

MoveIN Smart Match / AI Email

IN-89 · MOVEIN · MOVEIN · MAHESH · BUILDING

Lumina upgraded to latest version; Instance Leaderboard; expanded AI agent capabilities; Instant Brand Profile Extraction; AI Resource Transparency. Instant Brand Profile Extraction accelerates new client onboarding by automatically detecting brand typography, buttons and site languages directly from an institution's URL. Campaign creation sped up with one-click template duplication, smart prompt suggestions and real-time size validation to prevent email clipping. Automated Design Polish ensures professional, brand-compliant emails by managing header/footer logo dimensions and image alignment without custom code. Human-readable AI token usage metrics (e.g. 175.4K / 2B) help administrators monitor consumption. In-app announcements introduce the AI email generator to first-time users.

Risks and decisions. Penetration test reports under evaluation; any findings requiring remediation could create additional work. OpenAI Assistants API deprecation: an alternative has been identified.

Partnerships New

IN-16 · BLR2 · BLR2 · SIMON HALL · BLR1 · SIMON HALL · BLR1 · SCOPING

Platform Stats dashboard; Profile Analytics with trend charts and audience profiling. BLR1: QPD filtering delivered, in stakeholder validation. Delivered Profile Analytics with preset and custom date ranges, totals and trend charts, comparison against the preceding period, visitor-source and search-criteria breakdowns, and anonymised audience profiling (type, size, research volume, focus); performance figures restricted to the institution's own admins and QS internal reviewers. Delivered internal Platform Stats dashboard covering adoption, network overview, opportunity engagement, interest activity and time-to-value, with full data export for offline reporting. Tightened admin recognition via central product access so admin-only areas (e.g. My Partnerships) surface correctly without portal-level role setup.

BLR2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

MyQS Rankings: Extended embargo access controls so internal QS users and factfiles admins see embargoed assets ahead of publication, with a 2-day early-access window automatically applied for QS One subscribers. Fixed a broken link in the Rankings action plans area. CSM Knowledge Base (HubSpot): Kicked off the HubSpot CSM project — explored Design Manager and module structure, added custom CSS for buttons and cards, and completed initial UI styling and refinements.

BLR1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

HUB2: Completed development and QA validation for the Financial Aid bulk upload fix, ensuring uploaded data is correctly reflected within the user interface. Resolved the programme editing issue responsible for false "programme already opened in another tab" warnings, with validation completed in QA and deployment progression towards staging and production environments. Completed development activities supporting batch client publishing, with production rollout pending final publishing activities and operational readiness. Delivered code changes required for QSA Directory enablement, with release readiness dependent on completion of institution data verification activities.

ECU1 and ECU2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Release 74.18.4: Updated the learner platform sidebar. Configured default providers for courses from the database. Cleaned up tables that are no longer in use. Improved the top bar in Career Trends. Specialised majors by instance and institution. Limited occupations by instance. Fixed minor bugs.

MoveIN

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Lumina upgraded to latest version: Introduces 30+ security fixes, safer login handling, improved performance, enhanced accessibility and a more streamlined user experience. Supports the latest Google and OpenAI models and enables users to create, manage, redirect, pause and coordinate AI agents for more complex workflows. Introduces Projects folders, pinned favourites, a redesigned sidebar, usage visibility and selected voice/podcast capabilities. Data Management and Team Efficiency: Simplified CSV Data Importer reduces import errors with an intuitive import-selection flow and a clear pre-import summary of new versus updated records.

Infrastructure

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

MoveON: Strengthened automated security checks for exposed credentials and reviewed remediation progress with the team. MoveIN: Completed UKF University SSO configuration.

MoveIN

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Penetration test reports under evaluation. Any findings requiring remediation could create additional work. OpenAI Assistants API deprecation. An alternative has been identified.

Infrastructure

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. MoveON: Telemaxx migration. Remaining platform migration activities require completion following execution challenges. MoveON: SigNoz ClickHouse. Memory utilisation requires further stabilisation. MoveON: Automox. Approval remains pending with the DPO team. MoveIN: RabbitMQ. Production cutover remains pending live integration.

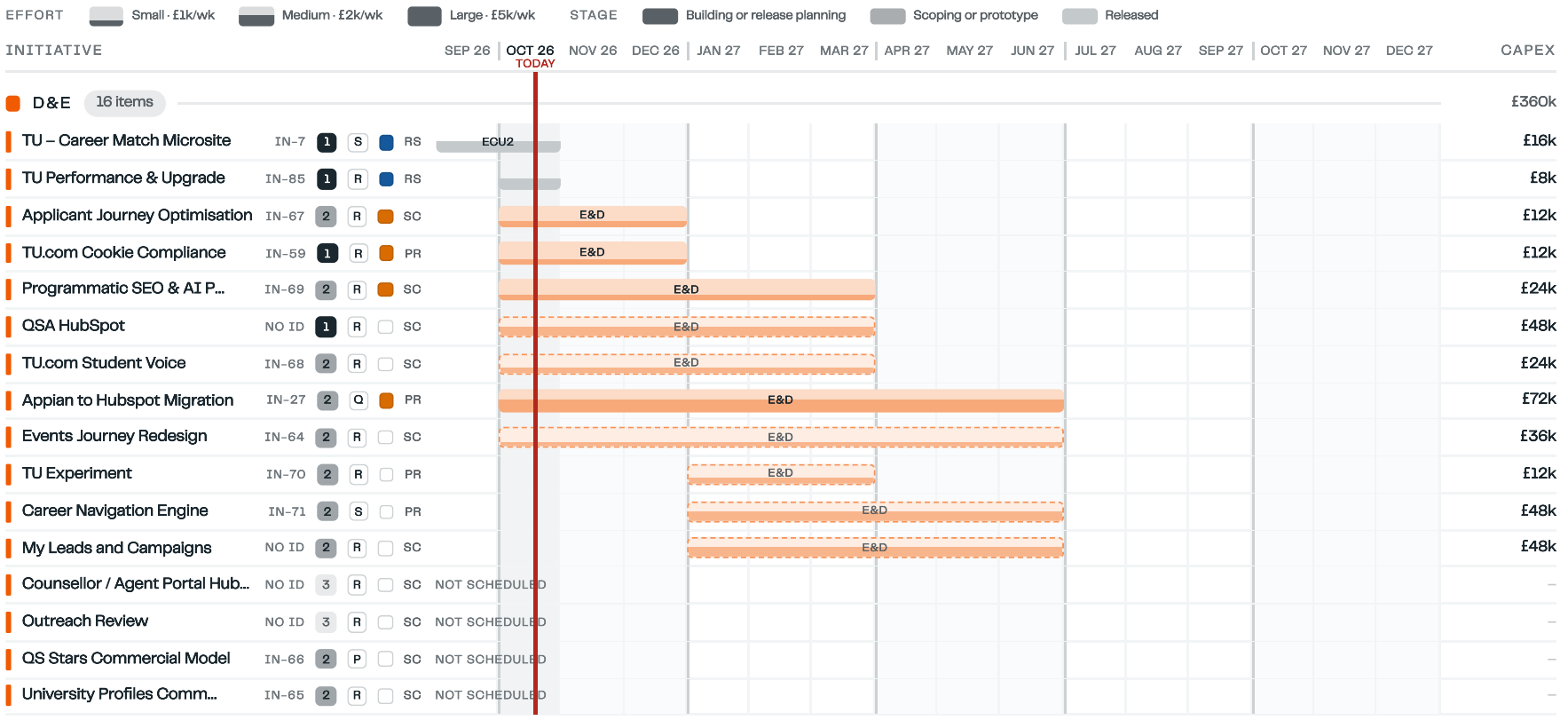
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 4 OF 5

D&E

2 initiatives reported

2 released



TOTAL CAPEX — 12 of 16 initiatives scheduled · 6 small, 6 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £144k approved by the investment committee, £216k not yet — £360k

TU – Career Match Microsite

IN-7 · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · CATARINA CUNHA · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

This has been tested, is waiting for release.

TU Performance & Upgrade

IN-85 · D&E · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · CATARINA CUNHA · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

Angular 14→21 shipped with no downtime; TU performance items continuing. What has been done is released, but we continued with this task by resolving errors and deletion of modules, since we have capacity. Some implementations done have been released, and we will continue with new tickets this sprint. Angular upgrade done, from version 14 to 21, no issues reported and no downtime.

Digital and Events

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

GME rankings: Released on the 16th. Agenda builder: Testing is still ongoing, delayed due to Angular testing priority. Drupal 11: Aiming to conclude it in the next sprint, now fixing final issues before sending it to testing.

QS Apply (Appian)

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Production support: No ongoing production fixes or investigations to report this week.

D&E

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Completed end-to-end Apache Solr provisioning automation using CDK and Jenkins deployment pipelines for TU/TM/QSC.

D&E

RISKS AND DECISIONS

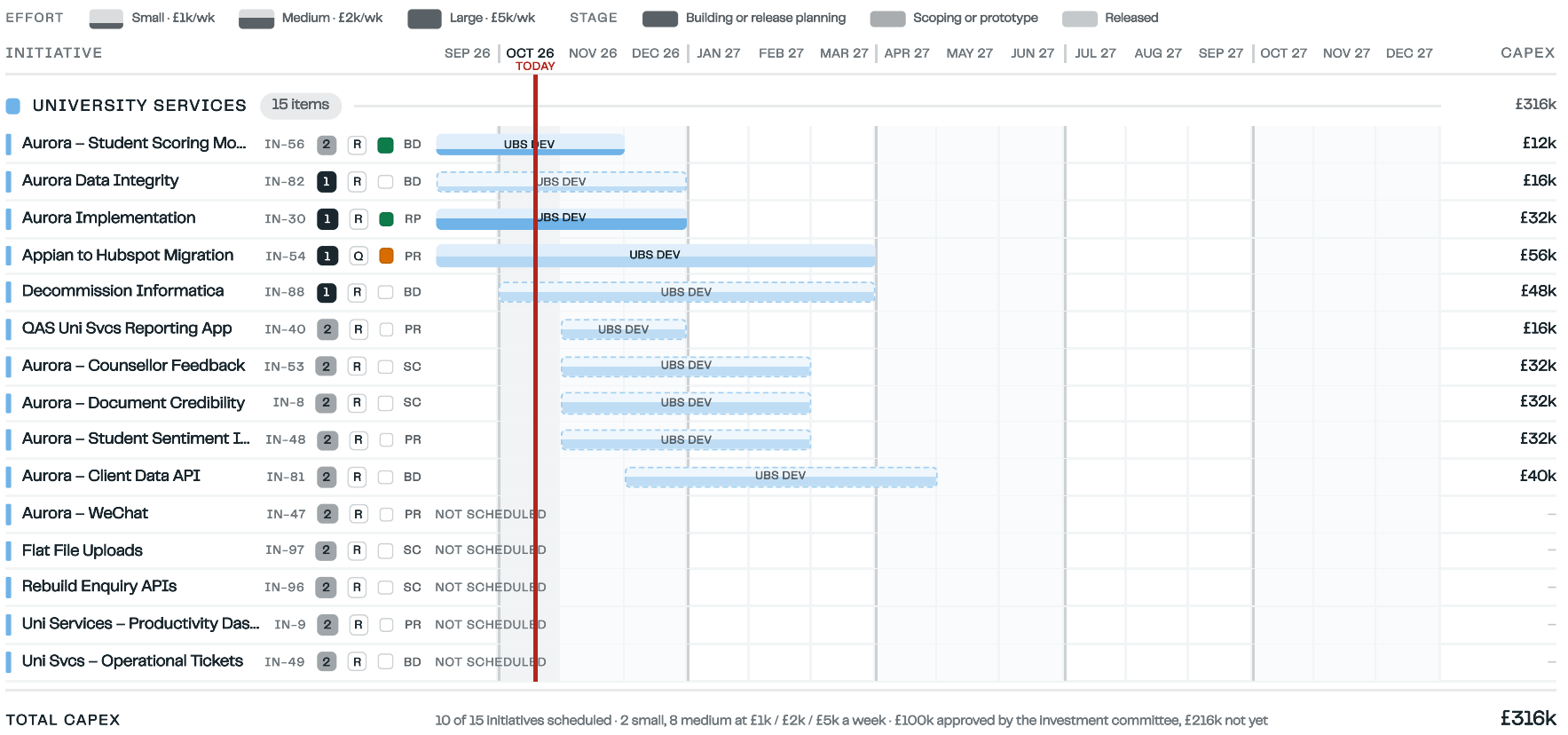
Risks and decisions. QS RMS (CN) CSV upload. Requires development-team optimisation. Automox. Approval remains pending with the DPO team. Bitdefender. Approval and legal documentation remain pending. Hub1 staging. Login issue investigation remains open and will require dev support.

SECTION 5 OF 5

University Services

2 initiatives reported

1 prototype
1 building



Appian to Hubspot Migration

IN-54 · QS APPLY · QS APPLY · SREERAM SREEKUMAR · UBS DEVELOPMENT · MOHD AZHAR MOHD RAZMAN · UBS DEVELOPMENT · QS APPLY (APPIAN) · PROTOTYPE

discovery workshops continuing. UBS Dev: four client replacements ready for testing. The discovery phase is now under way, with stakeholder workshops in progress to understand the current-state processes, system usage, pain points and opportunities for improvement across the Applicant and Application Journey and Admissions processes. Replacements for ACU, ECU, Keele and RCA are ready for testing. Griffith has undergone QA, with some fixes required following the initial review.

Risks and decisions. Contact Matching unavailable in Sandbox: issues promoting data from production to sandbox due to missing data objects. Tag data ingestion: need to agree how tag data should be ingested so it loads correctly into Contact Source, and replicate it in Sandbox for QA.

Decommission Informatica

IN-88 · UBS DEV · UBS DEVELOPMENT · MOHD AZHAR MOHD RAZMAN · UBS DEVELOPMENT · BUILDING

Stirling and ECU development continuing; Griffith QA under way; Brighton awaiting testing; decision not to renew communicated to procurement. Griffith's replacement is awaiting deployment, pending the API replacement. Brighton's replacement has been developed and is awaiting testing. Stirling and ECU development work is under way. Two of three replacements (RCA and ECU) have been built in the test environment and are now ready for testing. Initial round of testing concluded for RCA with a few small fixes needed.

Risks and decisions. Informatica will not be renewed. Procurement has been notified of the decision not to renew. LSBU is paused: its S3 flat-file replacement is on hold pending tender outcome.

CX Systems

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Aircall: continued user onboarding and investigated the Derby lines call-drop issue. Sakari: continued working with Sakari Support on the missing Sender ID issue and progressed UAE Sender ID setup for specific universities. QS Events: progressed the Sakari setup and HubSpot integration. US Numbers: coordinated with Sakari regarding US local number availability and permissions for QS Events. Niswey: coordinated with the QS Events team on the Niswey setup. Sender ID registration: coordinated with the team to collect required client details for alphanumeric Sender ID registration. Team operations: managed team handovers and offboarding activities. QS Dev: worked on resolving the Facebook account MFA issue.

UBS Development

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Contact Matching unavailable in Sandbox. Issues promoting data from production to sandbox due to missing data objects. Checking with Simon when he returns from leave. University of London sandbox licensing. Missing required licensing to proceed with development. Simon is arranging access. Tag data ingestion. Need to agree how tag data should be ingested so it loads correctly into Contact Source. Needs replication in Sandbox for QA. HubSpot x HubSpot integration.

CX Systems

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. US local numbers. Sakari US local numbers do not currently appear to be available, which may delay the QS Events setup. Sender ID validation. Effectiveness will be confirmed through testing and production usage. Final results expected once destination-country registration is completed.